

Citizens Energy Server Security Hardening Project

Opportunity Overview

- Citizens sought to take the next step in securing its development, testing, and production servers.
- The request was to implement industry-tested and proven security baselines that would harden systems, protect against malicious threats, and bring consistency to server builds and configurations.

Our Understanding of the Challenge

- Prior to this engagement, Citizens did not have a standardized server build or hardening process.
- Configurations were mostly manual and inconsistent, leaving gaps in security.
- While Microsoft security baselines were already in use for Windows 10 desktops, the same discipline had not yet been extended to the server infrastructure.

Scope of Services Delivered

As a subcontractor, DET executed the following:



Active Directory Re-Design

Assisted in the creation of a new OU structure aligned with Microsoft best practices and Citizens' business requirements.



Group Policy Implementation

- Helped develop and implement new GPOs to apply Microsoft Security Baselines on servers.
- Adjusted policies for compatibility with client requirements.
- Replicated existing policies where needed.



Server Migrations

- Migrated ~242 servers into the new OU structure with standardized security settings.
- 133 servers migrated during business hours, 109 servers migrated after hours/weekends.



Testing & Validation

Ensured applications functioned properly post-move and troubleshoot issues in real time.



Compliance & Continuous Improvement

- Conducted Qualys compliance scans on all Windows servers.
- Tuned GPOs as required in collaboration with Citizens.



Documentation & Knowledge Transfer

- Delivered a back-out strategy, migration strategy, and detailed documentation.
- Conducted a knowledge transfer session with Citizens staff.

How We Worked

We collaborated closely with Citizens stakeholders, engaging in:

- Project planning sessions
- Technical working sessions
- Weekly status reports covering accomplishments, next steps, roadblocks, and hours worked

This ensured full transparency, accountability, and smooth coordination.